

STATEMENT OF POLICY AND PROCEDURE

Section: NLLS Board | Chapter: Vision and Policy Statements | Page(s): 2

Subject: **GOVERNANCE & POLICY DEVELOPMENT** | Sec 2, 1B

Reviewed: 2021/11/06 | Revised: 2021/11/27 | **Effective: 2017/05/13**

SECTION 2 – 1.B

GOVERNANCE

1. Role of the Board and Trustee

- a) The Board shall meet and deliberate at specific and regular times as determined by its members and in accordance with the Alberta Libraries Act.
- b) The Board shall exercise its role as public trustees for the Municipalities that ~~comprise~~ **make-up** the Northern Lights Library System (NLLS).
- c) The Board is responsible for creating a vision of library service for the System, articulating values, and principles, setting goals, developing effective governance policy, monitoring library performance, and meeting provincial standards.
- d) The Board member is appointed by their council and, while representing the interest of their community, are required to act in the interest of NLLS.
- e) **The Board is responsible for orienting new members to their roles and responsibilities as trustees.**
- f) **Board members are responsible for ensuring they understand their responsibilities as trustees.**
- g) **The Board maintains a membership in the Alberta Library Trustees Association (ALTA) to ensure its trustees have access to appropriate professional development opportunities and resources.**

2. ~~Trustee Checklist~~

- a) ~~An easy way for Board members to understand their responsibilities more clearly and to meet them is to use checklists like the ones below. The Alberta Library Trustees' Association has many learning resources for trustees. There are learning modules available for personal learning or sharing with Boards on ALTA's website: <http://www.librarytrustees.ab.ca/trustee-learning>.~~
- b) ~~The following are some tools to help with becoming an effective board member.~~

3. Expectations of a Board Member:

- a) ~~Acknowledge attendance minimum of one (1) week before in advance of meeting(s).~~ Notify the NLLS administration of their intention to attend scheduled meetings one (1) week in advance.
- b) Arrive at meetings on time prepared to actively participate.
- c) Prepare reports, motions, etc., in writing if possible, and submit **them** to the NLLS administration **Board Secretary** in sufficient time for distribution before the meeting.
- d) Read Board material in advance of meetings, noting comments and questions.
- e) Follow through on assigned activities.
- f) ~~Notify the Chair in plenty of time about items for the agenda.~~
- g) Develop a working knowledge of ~~the~~ Board ~~manual~~ **materials** and applicable legislation.
- h) Maintain friendly, positive relationships with other Board members and staff.
- i) Ask **clarifying** questions.**!**
- j) Participate in discussion and decision-making, ensuring that you offer your relevant comments and suggestions prior to the Board's decisions.
- k) In addition to these general responsibilities, Board members are expected to serve on committees as required.

4. The Job of the Board is to liaise with the municipalities and members' libraries to:

- a) Determine NLLS's **strategic direction** through a **plan of service**. ~~what they want the System to be through the plan of service.~~
- b) Determine ~~how~~ **what** NLLS **will be governed** ~~system should accomplish~~ by developing policies.
- c) Prioritize ~~Determine~~ service levels through the development of ~~an~~ **the** annual budget.
- d) Advocate for **the interests of the** Northern Lights Library System **and other library services** in Alberta.
- e) Create partnerships with other agencies to achieve the System's vision, mission, beliefs, goals, and objectives.

5. ~~Write governing policies which, at the broadest levels, define:~~

- a) ~~Vision, Mission, Belief, Goals, and Objectives: Which long-range benefits will be achieved for whom, and at what cost.~~
 - b) ~~Governance Process: How the Board conceives, carries out and monitors its own job.~~
 - c) ~~Board / Executive Director Relationship: Establish policies that govern the relationship between Board as a whole and the Executive Director, and between the elected Executive and the Executive Director.~~
 - d) ~~Executive Director / Employee Relationship: Establish policies that govern all aspects of organization operations with input from the Executive Committee. For Example: HR policies, IT policies etc.~~
 - e) ~~Executive Director's Parameters: Those boundaries of prudent and ethical behavior within which the Executive Director can operate.~~
6. Develop and approve a three-year plan of service or a strategic plan, a rolling three-year budget, the provincial annual report, and audited financial statements.
 7. Recognize the value and contributions of long-serving employees(s), volunteers, and trustees.
 8. Monitor achievement efficacy and or compliance with policies against criteria, the Board has previously set, using:
 - a) reports by the Executive Director,
 - b) reports from member municipalities, members' libraries, and outside agencies,
 - c) direct inspection by the Board.
 9. Use the results of this monitoring to inform regular policy revision. ~~improve performance by:~~
 - a) ~~reviewing existing policies as per review schedule~~
 - b) ~~revising existing policies as required~~
 - c) ~~formulating new policies as required~~
 10. ~~The term of office of the Northern Lights Library System Board Chair is limited to two (2) consecutive two (2) year terms, unless at least 2/3 of the whole board passes a resolution stating that the Chair may be reappointed for more than two (2) consecutive terms.~~
 11. ~~Notwithstanding the Systems agreement mandatory seats, the term of office for a Northern Lights Library System Executive Member is limited to two (2) consecutive two-year terms, unless at least 2/3 of the whole board passes a resolution stating that member may be reappointed for more than two (2) consecutive terms.~~
 12. ~~Meet a minimum of four (4) times per year as per the Libraries Act; Section 33, and as defined in the Northern Lights Library System Agreement. A quorum of the Board shall be a simple majority of the entire board plus one (1). Meetings can be held at NLLS headquarters or virtually.~~
 13. ~~Create procedures providing for the orientation and ongoing development of trustees as they fulfill their ethical and legal duties to the regional library system.~~

POLICY MAKING DEVELOPMENT

~~The Board believes that~~ Policies provide parameters for the action of the Board, its committees, staff, and member libraries. The Board expects Northern Lights Library System's people to know the policies related to their duties. ~~Northern Lights Library System~~ As per The Library Act and Regulation the Board exercises responsible governance by establishing policies., ~~which forms a framework within which the Northern Lights Library System Board and staff will carry out their duties.~~

1. ~~The Board is responsible for the policies adopted by NLLS Northern Lights Library System.~~
2. With assistance from the administration, the Northern Lights Library System Board regularly reviews existing policies to ensure that they are up to date, in keeping with the government legislation and regulations and reflecting evolving needs of the System, by:
 - a) All policies are reviewed annually.
 - b) The most current Plan of Service shall supply content guidance.
 - c) A list of policies, together with prescribed reviewed dates of each policy, shall be maintained for the Board for their review.
 - d) Policies requiring revision shall be presented to the Executive Committee for review before proceeding to a vote of the Board.
 - e) Policy review dates will be expressly recorded on the policy, tracked, and acknowledged through signature by the Board Chair.
3. Policies shall be:
 - a) Proposed by any stakeholder in the operation and management of Northern Lights Library System to the Executive Committee via the Board Policy Review Committee.
 - b) Monitored by the Executive Director and Executive Committee.
 - c) Approved by the Board as a whole.

Policy Development

1. Policies will be developed and reviewed by the Board Policy Review committee with assistance from NLLS staff and administration throughout the calendar year.
2. The Executive Director will maintain a schedule for the annual review of all policies and bring forward new and updated policies to the Policy Review Committee.
3. The Board Policy Review Committee will:
 - a) track all policies and faithfully record review dates.
 - b) draft, revise, or update policies as requested by the Executive Committee.
 - c) review all policies annually and regularly bring policies forward to the Executive Committee for review or revision when required.
 - d) forward electronically all policies and policy revisions to the Executive Director to distribute to all staff for their feedback a minimum of five (5) business days before presentation to the Executive Committee.
 - e) consider all feedback and policies submitted by staff, or interested stakeholders, and act in the best interest of Northern Lights Library System.
4. The Executive Committee will:
 - a) consider all policies submitted by the Board Policy Review Committee, and act in the best interest of the Northern Lights Library System.
 - b) forward electronically all policies they approve for adoption or revision to the entire Board and NLLS staff 21 days before a vote is taken.
5. The Board will:
 - a) Individually review all new or revised policies in advance of any vote.
 - b) Provide feedback, concerns, or questions regarding proposed policies to the Executive Committee and/or Policy Review Committee Chair at least 48 hours prior to the meeting scheduled for a vote.
6. When presenting the Board with new or revised policies for a vote:
 - a) they will be presented as a package (an omnibus motion).
 - b) motions to remove one (1) or more policies from the policy package (omnibus motion) for a separate vote will be entertained.
 - c) amendments of policies will not be entertained at the General Board meetings.
 - d) defeated policies will be sent back to the Policy Review Committee for further review.

NLLS Executive Board Chair

November 27, 2021

Date of Approval